Module -3 Staying Physically Healthy

What is Physical Wellness?

Physical wellness means taking care of oneself, enjoying good health and staying away from diseases. Hence, physical wellness is all about making healthy lifestyle choices consistently. This includes consuming a healthy and balanced diet, engaging in physical activity daily, keeping your body weight in check, getting enough sleep, staying hydrated and avoiding tobacco and alcohol. These small yet essential changes can go a long way in boosting your immunity, energy levels and overall wellbeing.

Signs Indicating Good Physical Wellness

The following signs indicate good physical wellness:

- You sleep well at night and wake up fresh in the morning.
- You feel strong and energetic.
- Your heart and brain functions normally.
- You have a strong immunity.
- Your skin looks radiant and healthy.
- You have a healthy weight.
- In case of females, your menstrual cycles are regular

Why is physical wellness important?

Prioritizing your physical well-being is essential for enhancing your quality of life.

Whether addressing illness, boosting vitality, improving mobility, or managing weight, taking proactive steps can significantly improve your overall well-being in terms of:

1.Heart health: Maintaining physical fitness, including regular physical activity, is essential for heart health, helping to lower blood pressure, boost circulation, and reduce the risk of cardiovascular disease.

2.Maintaining a healthy weight: Weight management is essential for overall well-being. Being a healthy weight can reduce the risk of experiencing a range of diseases and illnesses, such as type 2 diabetes, osteoarthritis, kidney disease, high blood pressure, and more. Exercising, eating nutritiously, and getting adequate rest (and sometimes accessing appropriate medical support) all contribute to attaining and maintaining a healthy body weight.

3.Better longevity: Improving your physical well-being with routine physical activity (not for work purposes) can reduce your mortality risk, helping you live a longer, healthier life. An extensive literature review published by the British Journal of Sports Medicine in 2023 found that if everyone did even half the recommended amount of physical activity, 1 in 10 premature deaths would be prevented.

4.Improved mental health: Physical wellness can also have ripple effects on your mental well-being. Exercising is linked to lower levels of anxiety, stress, and depression. Regularly moving offers many positive benefits, such as better sleep and mood, increased libido, and enduring energy.

5.Enhanced balance: Good balance is essential to physical wellness as you age. It reduces the risk of a falling injury (and increases your ability to pick yourself up from a fall). Strengthening, flexibility, and mobility exercises can all help improve your balance.

Benefits of Physical Wellness

Want to feel better, have more energy and even add years to your life? Just exercise.

The health benefits of regular exercise and physical activity are hard to ignore. Everyone benefits from exercise, no matter their age, sex or physical ability.

Need more convincing to get moving? Check out these seven ways that exercise can lead to a happier, healthier you.

1. Exercise controls weight

Exercise can help prevent excess weight gain or help you keep off lost weight. When you take part in physical activity, you burn calories. The more intense the activity, the more calories you burn.

Regular trips to the gym are great, but don't worry if you can't find a large chunk of time to exercise every day. Any amount of activity is better than none. To gain the benefits of exercise, just get more active throughout your day. For example, take the stairs instead of the elevator or rev up your household chores. Consistency is key.

2. Exercise combats health conditions and diseases

Worried about heart disease? Hoping to prevent high blood pressure? No matter what your current weight is, being active boosts high-density lipoprotein (HDL) cholesterol, the "good" cholesterol, and it decreases unhealthy triglycerides. This one-two punch keeps your blood flowing smoothly, which lowers your risk of heart and blood vessel, called cardiovascular, diseases.

Regular exercise helps prevent or manage many health problems and concerns, including:

- Stroke.

- Metabolic syndrome.
- High blood pressure.
- Type 2 diabetes.
- Depression.
- Anxiety.
- Many types of cancer.
- Arthritis.
- Falls.

It also can help improve cognitive function and helps lower the risk of death from all causes.

3. Exercise improves mood

Need an emotional lift? Or need to lower stress after a stressful day? A gym session or brisk walk can help. Physical activity stimulates many brain chemicals that may leave you feeling happier, more relaxed and less anxious.

You also may feel better about your appearance and yourself when you exercise regularly, which can boost your confidence and improve your self-esteem.

4. Exercise boosts energy

Winded by grocery shopping or household chores? Regular physical activity can improve your muscle strength and boost your endurance.

Exercise sends oxygen and nutrients to your tissues and helps your cardiovascular system work more efficiently. And when your heart and lung health improve, you have more energy to tackle daily chores.

5. Exercise promotes better sleep

Struggling to snooze? Regular physical activity can help you fall asleep faster, get better sleep and deepen your sleep. Just don't exercise too close to bedtime, or you may be too energized to go to sleep.

6. Exercise puts the spark back into your sex life

Do you feel too tired or too out of shape to enjoy physical intimacy? Regular physical activity can improve energy levels and give you more confidence about your physical appearance, which may boost your sex life.

But there's even more to it than that. Regular physical activity may enhance arousal for women. And men who exercise regularly are less likely to have problems with erectile dysfunction than are men who don't exercise.

7. Exercise can be fun — and social!

Exercise and physical activity can be fun. They give you a chance to unwind, enjoy the outdoors or simply do activities that make you happy. Physical activity also can help you connect with family or friends in a fun social setting.

Tips to Improve Physical Wellness

Some simple tips that can help promote your physical wellness are:

1.Keep your body moving: Avoid sitting in one place for a long, especially if you have a desk job. Take regular breaks every 30-45 minutes to move and stretch your body. This can prevent muscle fatigue, and these small breaks are crucial for maintaining good brain function and emotional wellness.

2.Have a workout routine: This is important to strengthen the bones and muscles and avoid associated injuries. Regular exercise and stretches also help to improve your flexibility, cardiovascular health, and energy levels. Aim to get at least 30 minutes of moderate physical activity daily.

3.Engage in strength training: This can help strengthen your bones and muscles and help you enjoy a healthy and happy life. Strength training can also help you continue doing the activities you enjoy at any stage of life.

4.Consume a healthy diet: Include more fresh fruits, vegetables, beans, nuts, eggs, lean meat and other healthy foods in your diet to promote your physical wellness. Get more fibre and complex carbs and avoid foods high in salt and sugar.

5.Maintain a healthy weight: Maintaining a healthy weight can make you feel more active and energetic. It can also help to reduce the risk of heart conditions, diabetes and certain types of cancer. To maintain a healthy weight, eat small portions of food, including more fruits and vegetables in your diet, limit the intake of oils, fats and sugar, and engage in some physical activity every day.

6.Take care of your metabolism: Metabolism, or the process of converting food into energy, changes with age. Since your metabolism slows down as you grow older, you need to make necessary changes in your diet and consume foods that are easy on the digestive system. Also, drink more water, limit snacking, be active, and get restful sleep at night.

7.Be mindful of alcohol consumption: Limit alcohol consumption to prevent alcohol poisoning. It is a condition that prevents the body from performing vital functions, such as breathing, temperature regulation and maintaining consciousness. It can also cause vomiting, irregular breathing, pale skin, and seizures.

What is Physical fitness?

Physical fitness is one's ability to execute daily activities with optimal performance, endurance, and strength with the management of disease, fatigue, stress and reduced sedentary behavior.

Importance of Physical fitness

To put it simply, physical activity and exercise is important for everyone. Children, adolescents, and adults of all ages need regular physical activity. Physical activity promotes good health, and you should stay active throughout all stages of your life regardless of your body type or BMI.

Understanding the benefits of physical fitness and knowing how active you should be can help you maintain good health and improve your overall quality of life.

Here are a few benefits of regular physical activity that demonstrate the importance of physical fitness.

1.Save money

According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, chronic diseases cause 7 out of 10 deaths in the U.S., and treating chronic diseases accounts for 86% of U.S. healthcare costs. While some diseases cannot be prevented, you can reduce your risk for certain disease – such as heart disease and diabetes – through reducing risky behaviors and living a healthy lifestyle.

Making healthy choices, such as engaging in regular physical activity, can reduce your risk for many health issues and complications that can result in expensive medical care.

2.Increase your life expectancy

Numerous studies have shown that regular physical activity increases life expectancy and reduces the risk of premature mortality. There's not a magic formula that translates hours of physical activity into hours of life gained, but research suggests that people who are more active tend to be healthier and tend to live longer.

3.Reduce your risk of injury

Regular exercise and physical activity increase muscle strength, bone density, flexibility, and stability. Physical fitness can reduce your risk for and resilience to accidental injuries, especially as you get older. For

example, stronger muscles and better balance mean that you're less likely to slip and fall, and stronger bones mean that your less likely to suffer bone injuries should you take a tumble.

4.Improve your quality of life

A sedentary lifestyle and a lack of physical activity can take a toll on a person's body. Physical inactivity is associated with an increased risk for certain types of cancer, numerous chronic diseases, and mental health issues. Exercise, however, has been shown to improve mood and mental health, and provides numerous health benefits. Of course physical fitness also allows you to do things that you may not otherwise be able to do.

5.Stay active

Staying active and healthy allows you to do activities that require a certain level of physical fitness. For example, hiking to the top of a mountain is a rewarding experience that instills a sense of accomplishment and provides spectacular scenery, but there are people who cannot experience this due to fitness limitations.

But even walking around the zoo with your family or playing on the playground with your children can be challenging for those who neglect physical activity for extended periods of time. Being active means that it's easier to stay active as you get older.

6.Improve your health

There are numerous health advantages to physical fitness. Regular exercise and physical activity promotes strong muscles and bones. It improves respiratory, cardiovascular health, and overall health. Staying active can also help you maintain a healthy weight, reduce your risk for type 2 diabetes, heart disease, and reduce your risk for some cancers.

In other words, staying active is a crucial part of maintaining good health and wellness.

What is Yoga?

Yoga is essentially a spiritual discipline based on an extremely subtle science, which focuses on bringing harmony between mind and body. It is an art and science of healthy living. The word 'Yoga' is derived from the Sanskrit root 'Yuj', meaning 'to join' or 'to yoke' or 'to unite'. As per Yogic scriptures the practice of Yoga leads to the union of individual consciousness with that of the Universal Consciousness, indicating a perfect harmony between the mind and body, Man & Nature. According to modern scientists, everything in the universe is just a manifestation of the same quantum firmament. One who experiences this oneness of existence is said to be in yoga, and is termed as a yogi, having attained to a state of freedom referred to as mukti, nirvana or moksha. Thus the aim of Yoga is Self-realization, to overcome all kinds of sufferings leading to 'the state of liberation' (Moksha) or 'freedom' (Kaivalya). Living with freedom in all walks of life, health

and harmony shall be the main objectives of Yoga practice. "Yoga" also refers to an inner science comprising of a variety of methods through which human beings can realize this union and achieve mastery over their destiny.

Types Of Yoga:

Hatha Yoga:

This is one of the oldest forms of yoga which includes the practice of asanas (Postures) and pranayama (breathing exercise) which brings peace to mind and body, and helps prepare the body for deeper spiritual practices such as meditation.

Vinyasa Yoga:

An active and athletic style of yoga adapted from the traditional ashtanga system in the late 1980s. It essentially means movement synchronized with breath and is a vigorous style based on the rapid flow through sun salutation. It also refers to the continuous flow from one posture to another.

Ashtanga Yoga:

Ashtanga is a system of yoga that was brought to the modern world by Sri K. Pattabhi Jois. This form of yoga includes six series and each series is a set sequence of asanas, always in the same order. It is typically fast-paced, vigorous and physically challenging.

Power Yoga:

Power yoga is described as vigorous, vinyasa-style yoga. Power yoga's popularity has spread across the globe and is now taught everywhere. Because the style can vary, it is recommended that you consult the individual instructor before performing it.

Bikram Yoga:

It consists of twenty-six postures and two breathing techniques. This style of yoga helps flush toxins, manage weight and allow performers to move more deeply into postures.

Jivamukti Yoga:

This style of yoga was created in 1984. Chanting, meditation, readings and affirmations are done in this style of yoga.

Iyengar Yoga:

Poses are held much longer in this form of yoga in an effort to pay closer attention to the precise musculoskeletal alignment within each asana. Another trademark of iyengar is the use of props, such as blocks,

belts, bolsters, chairs and blankets, which are used to accommodate injuries, tightness or structural imbalances, as well as teach the student how to move properly into a posture.

Anusara Yoga:

The anusara style is a new system of hatha that teaches a set of Universal Principles of Alignment that underlie all yoga postures, while encouraging flowing with grace and following your heart. It is broadly categorized into three parts known as the three A's and they include attitude, alignment and action

Shivananda Yoga:

It typically begins with Savasana (relaxation pose), kapalabhati and anuloma viloma, followed by a few rounds of surya namaskara. Then it moves through Sivananda's twelve asanas, which together are designed to increase strength and flexibility of the spine. Chanting and meditation can also be a part of it.

Viniyoga:

Viniyoga refers to an approach to yoga that adapts the various means and methods of practice to the unique condition, needs and interests of the individual. This style of yoga helps in self-discovery and personal transformation.

Kundalini Yoga:

Kundalini incorporates multiple movements or exercises, dynamic breathing practices, chanting, meditation and mantras. Each specific kundalini exercise, referred to as a kriya, is a movement that is often repeated and is synchronized with the breath. The practice is designed to awaken the energy at the base of the spine in order to draw it upward through each of the seven chakras.

Yin Yoga:

Yin yoga is a slow-paced style in which poses are held for five minutes or longer. Even though it is passive, yin yoga can be quite challenging due to the long duration holds, particularly if your body is not used to it. The purpose is to apply moderate stress to the connective tissue - the tendons, fascia and ligaments - with the aim of increasing circulation in the joints and improving flexibility.

Yoga works on the level of one's body, mind, emotion and energy. This has given rise to four broad classifications of Yoga: karma yoga, where we use the body; bhakti yoga, where we use the emotions; gyana yoga, where we use the mind and intellect; and kriya yoga, where we use the energy. All the ancient commentaries on Yoga focus on performing the Yoga under the direction of a Guru. The reason being that only a Guru can mix the appropriate combination of the four fundamental paths, as is necessary for each seeker.

Now-a-days, millions and millions of people across the globe have been benefitted by practicing Yoga on daily basis which has been preserved and promoted by the great eminent Yoga Masters from ancient time to this date. The practice of Yoga is flourishing, and growing more vibrant every day.

Principles of Yoga

Yoga is a way of life. Yoga is a science, not a religion, of uniting the mind, body and soul. It is also an art of living the right way. The techniques of Yoga are very practical, so they can always be applied. This is the reason why Yoga has been practiced for thousands of years and is still valid today. This practical science can be broken down into five major principles.

1. Proper Exercise (Asanas)

Proper exercise is necessary to keep the body healthy, strong and flexible. The physical exercises or postures in Yoga are called asanas. Asanas are gentle stretches that help in lubricating the joints, muscles, tendons, ligaments, and other parts of the body. They also help to improve circulation, release tension in the body, increase flexibility and tone the nervous system. Asanas are meant to be performed in a slow, relaxed and methodical manner. In addition to developing the physical body, the mind is also impacted in a positive way. Most people find it difficult to calm the mind. We start with asanas to help start the process of calming the mind and to create a good foundation for the next steps.

2. Proper Breathing (Pranayama)

Due to our modern lifestyles most of us forget how to breathe. At best, our breathing becomes very shallow. All the cells and tissues in our bodies thrive on oxygen. Without an adequate supply of oxygen, our cells and tissues become weak, leading to diseases. Deep breathing provides an abundance of oxygen, which keeps the cells and tissues healthy. Upon exhalation, we expell impurities from our bodies. Lack of exhaling deeply does not remove enough impurities from our bodies. Shallow breathing then does not supply enough oxygen and does not expell enough impurities. The result is a toxic system, which is a perfect environment for diseases to form. With proper breathing techniques (pranayama) we can teach the body to breathe again. Pranayama not only purifies the system, but it also helps to connect the body to the solar plexus area where a tremendous potential energy is stored. This vital energy or prana is then released, rejuvenating the body and mind. The benefits of pranayama greatly outweigh those of asanas, so it is important to incorporate pranayama in one's regular practice.

3. Proper Relaxation (Savasana)

In these times we are measured by how much we can achieve and in the least amount of time. This causes us to be in constant motion. This constant motion then causes our bodies and minds to be overworked and stressed. Proper relaxation is yet another important factor we must incorporate into our regular practice in

order to allow the body and mind to recharge and rejuvenate. Rest and relaxation helps to calm the whole system. When we are in this state it is sometimes difficult to calm the system and even sleeping becomes difficult and doesn't help. Yogic relaxation techniques or savasana helps to calm the system by retraining the mind and body to relax.

4. Proper Diet and Nutrition

What we eat has a subtle impact on our health and wellbeing. For a number of reasons, a plant-based diet is optimal for good health. It enables the body to maximize the benefit from food, air, water as well as sunlight. It is also easy to digest and promotes good health. A Yogic diet is simple, natural and wholesome. Since the food we eat has a subtle impact, a Yogic diet helps to achieve better health as well as a sharp, yet calm mind.

5. Positive Thinking and Meditation

Our mind is what drives our body. A calm and steady mind is required to keep our bodies in optimal condition. Positive thinking helps to purify the mind and experience inner peace. When we shift our focus from negative thoughts to positive thoughts, it changes our perception of the world around us. We start to see things in a more positive light and negative situations stop affecting us in a strong way. Along with positive thinking, incorporating a regular meditation practice helps to keep the mind clear and focused.

All of the above is what Yoga is all about. It is not just about some poses. The idea is to have optimal physical and mental health, which then helps us to navigate life in a more graceful manner.

The Benefits of Yoga in the Workplace

There are numerous benefits to incorporating yoga into the workplace wellness program. Here are some of the key benefits of yoga in the workplace:

- **Reduces stress and anxiety:** Yoga is well known for its ability to reduce stress and anxiety levels. In the workplace, stress can have a significant impact on productivity and employee well-being. By incorporating yoga into the workday, employees can take a break from their daily tasks and focus on calming the mind and reducing stress.
- **Improves physical health:** Sitting for long periods and working at a computer can lead to poor posture, muscle stiffness, and back pain. Yoga helps to improve posture, flexibility, and strength, which can reduce the risk of musculoskeletal disorders and improve overall physical health.
- **Boosts energy and productivity**: Practicing yoga can help to increase energy levels and improve focus, leading to increased productivity in the workplace. By taking a short break to practice yoga, employees can return to their work feeling more alert and refreshed.

- **Creates a positive work environment:** Yoga can help to create a more positive and supportive work environment by promoting teamwork, communication, and a sense of community. Practicing yoga together can also help to build stronger relationships between colleagues.
- **Promotes overall well-being:** Regular yoga practice can have a significant impact on overall well-being, including reducing the risk of chronic diseases, improving mental health, and promoting better sleep. By incorporating yoga into the workplace, companies can help to support the health and well-being of their employees.

Yoga Vs Meditation

Yoga and meditation are two practices often mentioned in the same breath, but what exactly is the difference? Can they be done together, and which one is right for you? Let's explore the differences and connections between yoga and meditation in this article.

Yoga, originating in India thousands of years ago, is a holistic discipline that combines physical postures (asanas), breathing exercises (pranayama), and chanting. It's like a workout for both body and mind. On the other hand, meditation focuses on calming the mind and finding inner peace through techniques like mindfulness or visualization. So, while yoga is more active and involves movement, meditation is about stillness and mental focus.

The practice that combines yoga with meditation is often called yoga nidra, which translates to "yogic sleep." It's a deeply relaxing guided meditation that helps you become more aware and connected to your own body.

Here's a breakdown of the key differences:

1.Purpose: Meditation focuses on calming the mind, reducing stress, and promoting inner peace, while yoga aims to improve physical health, flexibility, and mental well-being through movement and breath awareness.

2.Focus: Yoga uses breathwork and movement to bring awareness to the present moment. Meditation trains the mind to focus on a single point, such as the breath or a mantra (a repeated word or phrase).

3.Duration: Yoga sessions can vary in length, ranging from a few minutes to over an hour, depending on the style and intensity, while meditation sessions can also vary but are typically shorter in duration, often starting with just a few minutes and gradually increasing over time.

4.Physicality: Yoga incorporates physical postures that improve flexibility, strength, and balance. Meditation is primarily a mental practice, done in a seated position.

5.Techniques: In meditation, techniques may include mindfulness, concentration, visualization, or guided imagery to cultivate awareness and mental clarity. In yoga, various techniques such as asanas (postures), pranayama (breath control), and relaxation methods are used to achieve physical and mental benefits.

6.Intensity: Yoga can range from gentle to very physically demanding. Meditation is generally a low-impact practice.

7.Goal: The ultimate goal of yoga is often seen as achieving union between the body, mind, and spirit, sometimes referred to as “yoga union” or “yoga harmony.” The goal of meditation is often to achieve a state of inner peace, clarity, and self-awareness.

What is Pranayama ?

Pranayama is the Ayurvedic practice of controlling your breath. You control the timing, duration, and frequency of every breath and hold. The goal of pranayama is to connect the body and mind.

What are the potential benefits of pranayama?

The benefits of pranayama have been extensively researched. Scientific studies have shown that pranayama may benefit health in various ways. Let’s examine six of these potential benefits in more detail.

1. Decreases stress

Pranayama may help to decrease stress levels when practised regularly.

A 2024 study examined the effectiveness of pranayama for front-line workers during the COVID-19 pandemic. Researchers found that practicing pranayama for four weeks could significantly decrease perceived stress levels and enhance psychological quality of life.

2. Improves sleep quality

Deep breathing practices like pranayama may help with sleep regulation, by requiring you to focus on your breath and promoting deep relaxation. This may be especially beneficial to those with insomnia.

According to a 2019 study, pranayama may also improve sleep quality in people with obstructive sleep apnea. Additionally, the study found that practicing pranayama decreased snoring and daytime sleepiness, suggesting benefits for better-quality rest.

3. Increases mindfulness

For many of us, breathing is automatic. We do it without giving it much thought at all.

But during pranayama, you need to be aware of your breathing and how it feels. You also practice focusing on the present moment, instead of the past or future. This is known as mindfulness.

4. Reduces high blood pressure

High blood pressure, or hypertension, is when your blood pressure reaches an unhealthy level. It increases the risk for some potentially serious health conditions like heart disease and stroke.

Stress is a major risk factor for high blood pressure. Pranayama may help minimize this risk by promoting relaxation.

5. Improves lung function

As a type of breathing exercise, the slow, intentional breathing of pranayama may help strengthen your lungs.

A 2019 study suggests that pranayama may improve the efficiency of healthy individuals and athletes by increasing lung function, especially in people who practice aerobic-based sports.

6. Reduces cigarette cravings

There is some evidence that yogic breathing, or pranayama, may reduce cravings in people who are trying to quit smoking.

A 2020 study found that mindfulness-based yoga breathing decreased the negative effects associated with smoking withdrawal.

Pranayama, or breath control, is a main component of yoga. It is frequently practiced with yoga postures and meditation. The goal of pranayama is to strengthen the connection between your body and mind.

According to research, pranayama can promote relaxation and mindfulness. It may also support multiple aspects of physical health, including lung function, blood pressure, and brain function.

Types of pranayama

Bhastrika Pranayama

In the Bhastrika pranayama, breathing is done rapidly followed by stopping the breath and releasing it forcefully.

Benefits of Bhastrika Pranayama: Reduce belly fat, Weight Loss, Asthma, and inflammation of the throat.

NadishodhanPranayam

Nadisodhan Pranayama is also called Anulom-Antonym. In this pranayama, you breathe through the left nasal cavity, hold the breath, and then slowly exhale through the right nostril and vice versa.

Benefits of Nadisodhan Pranayama: Reducing anxiety and stress, Increase Concentration and peace, peace, impart a free flow of energy in the body, Strengthen the immune system.

Kapalbhati pranayama

'Kapal' means skull and Bhati means to shine. Thus, Kapalabhati is such pranayama whose practice revives the actions of the head and brain. It also helps in awakening the Kundalini Shakti.

Benefits of Kapalbhati: Useful in weight loss, improving skin, preventing hair from whitening, reducing asthma, reducing mucus, treating sinusitis, improving digestion, enhancing lung capacity, removing the complaints of constipation, etc.

Ujjayi pranayama

This pranayama involves inhaling slowly from both nostrils, stopping the breath and exhaling the right nostril, and exhaling slowly from the left nostril. During inhalation, the neck is vibrated to produce a sound that is very important in this type of Pranayama.

Benefits of Ujjayi Pranayama: It slows down the aging process and is suitable for thyroids patients. Also, it helps in the flow of energy, body cooling, removing mucus, and is good for heart patients.

Sheetkari pranayama

The practice of this pranayama gives a feeling of coolness. The practice of this pranayama should be done more vigorously in the summer.

Benefits of Sheetkari Pranayama: Effective for reducing stress & anxiety, effective for depression, reducing anger, controlling hunger and thirst, lowering blood pressure, secreting hormones in genitals, calming the mind, etc.

Sheetli Pranayama

Sheetli Pranayama helps in cooling down the body, so it must be done during summer. Shitali Pranayama Benefits: It reduces stress, anxiety, depression, anger, and thirst. It lowers blood pressure and relieves indigestion.

Surya bhedana pranayama

In Surya Bhedana Pranayama, the breath is taken from the right nostril, the breath is stopped and the left nostril is released.

Benefits of Surya Bhedan Pranayama: avoid old age, eliminates stomach worms, removes air-borne disorders, reduces headaches, kundalinishakti awakening, low blood pressure, and lowering down respiratory problems.

Bhramri pranayama

During its practice, the nasal sound produces a humming sound, hence its name Bhramari.

Benefits of Bhramari Pranayama: It helps in calming the brain and reducing stress, anger, anxiety, and depression.

Plavini pranayama

By the practice of this pranayama, any person can swim in water like lotus leaves, hence the name Plavini.

Benefits of Plavini Pranayama: Useful to increase the digestion, lifespan, peace of mind and reduce stress.

Which pranayama is responsible for pushing your waste out of your body?

Kapalabhati is a pranayama practice as well as a shat kriya—one of the six cleansing actions of hatha yoga. With its emphasis on the exhalation, kapalabhati enhances elimination of volatile metabolic wastes and dispels sluggishness and congestion, while engaging the seat of apana in the lower belly.

The defining characteristic of kapalabhati is a sharp, forceful exhalation from the abdomen, followed immediately by a passive, relaxed inhalation. The inhalation and the exhalation are asymmetrical—the exhalation feels like a staccato note, and the inhalation is on the rebound. Therefore, it's important to quickly and completely relax after the exhalation.

A daily beginning practice consists of one to three rounds of 7 to 11 breaths at one breath every two seconds, resting between rounds. Add 5 to 10 breaths per round each week to increase your capacity, and gradually pick up speed to about one breath per second. Eventually you may practice for one to three minutes at this speed. If you feel dizzy or light-headed, feel a stitch in your side, or lose the rhythm, rest with normal breathing, and next time try fewer breaths, or consult a teacher to refine your technique.

In the beginning, focus your attention at the lower belly. Work to stabilize the body while keeping your exhalations deep and rhythmic. Then refine your practice with a one-pointed inner mental focus at the eyebrow center. The name kapalabhati means "illuminated skull"—promising a halo when the purification of body and mind is complete!

What is aerobic exercise?

Aerobic exercise is a physical activity that uses large muscle groups in your body. This type of exercise is usually rhythmic and repetitive. You can adjust the intensity of your workout, which is how hard your body works during this type of exercise.

Aerobic exercises increase your heart rate and how much oxygen your body uses. The term aerobic means "with oxygen." When you practice aerobic exercise, your breathing controls the amount of oxygen that reaches your muscles to help you burn energy and move.

What is the difference between aerobic and anaerobic exercises?

Aerobic and anaerobic are terms that define how your body produces energy. Aerobic means "with oxygen." When you participate in a continuous activity that increases your heart rate, your cells use oxygen to produce energy. An example of aerobic exercise is walking. Anaerobic means "without oxygen." When you engage in a quick, high-intensity activity, your cells aren't using oxygen to produce energy. An example of an anaerobic exercise is lifting weights.

What are examples of aerobic exercises?

There are a lot of different types of aerobic exercises. Some of the most common include:

- Walking or jogging.
- Cycling.
- Cardio equipment.
- Swimming.

1.Walking or jogging

Walking is one of the simplest and most available aerobic exercises. You can change the intensity to match your fitness level. Jogging is faster than walking but slower than running. Jogging puts more stress on your joints than walking and isn't recommended if you have an injury. Other than athletic shoes, this activity doesn't require any special equipment. You can walk almost anywhere: outdoors or indoors (malls, indoor tracks or a treadmill). This makes walking easy to continue throughout the year. Walking is a good choice for starting your first exercise program.

2.Cycling

Cycling is an aerobic exercise that you can do on a stationary bike or a regular bicycle. You can adjust the intensity of your exercise by choosing a higher setting on your stationary bike or riding on a route with more

hills or inclines. Cycling may be ideal if you have arthritis or other conditions that affect your joints. This activity helps your heart without putting too much mechanical stress on your back, hips, knees and ankles that walking can cause. If you cycle outdoors, the weather may limit your activity.

3.Cardio Equipment

Cardio equipment includes machines that increase your heart rate while you complete a repetitive motion. Some common types of cardio equipment are:

- A rowing machine.
- Stair climbers.
- An elliptical.
- A treadmill.

You can find these types of machines at your local gym or you can add one to your home. They're usually larger and can take up a lot of space if you choose to get one for at-home use. Since there are a lot of different types of cardio machines, you should try out different ones at a gym or fitness center first. It can take time to see which machine you enjoy most and which one puts less stress on areas of your body where you may have an injury or issue. Your healthcare provider can also recommend what type of cardio machine is best for you.

4.Swimming

Swimming is a low-impact activity where you use your arms and legs to propel you through the water. The intensity of swimming increases more in open water than it does in a pool. Water aerobics and water walking are good alternatives if you have joint pain. The buoyancy provided by the water eases stress on your joints. If you plan on swimming or participating in water activities, make sure you're swimming under the supervision of a lifeguard in case of an emergency.

What are the benefits of aerobic exercise?

The benefits of aerobic exercise include:

- Building stronger bones.
- Improving your muscle strength, endurance and flexibility.
- Improving your balance.
- Increasing your mental function.
- Assisting in weight management and/or weight loss.

In addition, aerobic exercise can:

- Reduce your risk of developing heart disease, hypertension, stroke or diabetes.
- Improve your lung function.
- Lower your blood pressure.
- Increase HDL or "good" cholesterol.
- Help to better manage your blood sugar.

What are the risks of aerobic exercises?

Participating in physical activities can put you at risk of injury, including:

- Sprains and strains.
- Bone fracture.
- Joint pain.
- Muscle cramps.
- Pain or soreness.

How do I keep myself safe while doing aerobic exercises?

You should talk with your healthcare provider before you start an exercise program. Ask what, if any, limitations you may have. If you have diabetes, hypertension, heart disease, arthritis, pulmonary conditions or other health conditions, you may need additional safety guidelines for exercise. The type of exercise you choose is a personal decision, but you should consider certain factors to reduce the risk of injury or complications and make exercise more enjoyable.

Preventing aerobic exercise injury

You can take steps to prevent injury during aerobic exercise by:

- Talking to your healthcare provider before starting regular physical activity.
- Learning how to use exercise equipment safely.
- Using good techniques and performing the exercise as instructed.
- Wearing proper gear or clothing.
- Being aware of your surroundings.
- Warming up and stretching.

If you develop symptoms during exercise including, but not limited to, unusual shortness of breath; tightness in the chest; chest, shoulder or jaw pain; lightheadedness; dizziness; confusion or joint pain, you should stop exercising immediately and contact your healthcare provider.

What is anerobic exercise?

Anaerobic exercise involves short, fast, high-intensity exercises that don't make your body use oxygen like it does for cardio (or aerobic) activities. Instead, anaerobic activities break down glucose that's already in your muscles for a form of energy.

Types of Anaerobic Exercise

Examples of anaerobic exercise include:

- High-intensity interval training (HIIT)
- Strength training and weight lifting that challenges your body
- Calisthenics like jump squats, box jumps, and plyometrics

Anaerobic exercise isn't easy, so it's important to find a certified personal trainer to help you develop a routine and learn proper form. Many gyms also offer classes that include anaerobic workouts.

Effects of Anaerobic Exercise on Your Health

Anaerobic exercise offers a number of health benefits. It can:

- Strengthen bones
- Burn fat
- Boost muscle development
- Help you keep muscle mass as you age

After age 27, you start to lose about 1% of your muscle mass each year. You can slow this loss by staying active and including anaerobic strength training in your exercise regimen.

Aerobic vs Anaerobic Exercises

While both aerobic and anaerobic exercise have their place in a well-rounded fitness routine, anaerobic exercise can be more effective for weight loss.

There's much debate about what type of exercise is better for your health: aerobic or anaerobic.

Aerobic exercise, like walking, bike riding, or running, means you're moving your body, breathing faster, and increasing your blood flow. It's a level of activity that you can maintain for an extended period of time.

Anaerobic exercise, like sprinting or weightlifting, is short, intense activity that has you working to the max, and it can't be sustained for long.

Characteristics	Aerobic Exercise	Anaerobic Exercise
Definition	This is exercise where oxygen is used to help the heart and cardiovascular. system.	This is exercise where glucose from muscle glycogen is used to provide energy and build strength.
Oxygen	Present	Absent
Duration and intensity	Long and sustained, more gentle types of exercise.	Exercises that are intense and done in short intervals.
Uses	Improves cardiovascular health.	Helps to build your strength and muscle and bone mass.
Pros	Helps the cardiovascular system.	Helps increase bone density and strength, and increase muscle strength and mass.
Cons	Can result in sprains and strains and repetitive injuries.	Does not help the heart as much as does aerobic exercise; high risk of injuries if you are not careful.

Oxygen Debt

Oxygen debt occurs when the body reaches a state of anaerobic respiration during intense exercise. When a person engages in high levels of physical activity, the body cannot distribute oxygen to the cells at a sufficiently rapid pace to keep up with the oxygen demand. This results in an oxygen deficit as the cells continue to produce energy but need additional oxygen to process the lactic acid produced during the process.

The body compensates for this temporary oxygen deficit by taking in more oxygen after a heavy workout. This process is called extra post-exercise oxygen consumption (EPOC). The difference between a person's normal oxygen intake and his or her intake after a strenuous workout is called **Oxygen Debt.**

Oxygen is used by the cells to produce energy using a process called aerobic respiration. During strenuous exercise, the body cannot deliver enough oxygen to the muscle cells. This status is referred to as on oxygen deficit. Once the body reaches a state of oxygen deficit during exercise, energy is produced using anaerobic respiration.

Anaerobic respiration breaks down glucose into energy that the cells can use to function. The process creates a waste substance called lactic acid. During aerobic respiration, this lactic acid is further broke down into carbondioxide and water. Oxygen is needed for this step to take place.

When the body lacks the necessary oxygen to complete the process of respiration and eliminate the lactic acid, it is said to be in oxygen debt. After an individual's activity level slows, he or she will take in extra oxygen to gradually repay this oxygen debt, allowing the cells to process the built-up lactic acid.

Removal of Oxygen Debt

The Recovery Phase

Post-exercise recovery is essential to address oxygen debt and neutralize lactic acid.

Sustained Elevated Heart Rate

Oxygen Transportation: The heart beats faster for a while after exercise to speed up oxygen distribution throughout the body.

Replenishing Oxygen Stores: This process helps refill the oxygen deficit incurred during the exercise.

Enhanced Breathing

Maximizing Oxygen Intake: Breathing becomes deeper post-exercise to increase oxygen uptake.

Crucial for Lactic Acid Breakdown: This additional oxygen is vital for processing the accumulated lactic acid.

Liver's Role in Lactic Acid Metabolism

Liver Function: One of the liver's key roles post-exercise is converting lactic acid back into glucose.

Gluconeogenesis: This process is crucial for decreasing lactic acid concentration in the bloodstream.

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